



HUMANITAS  
INSTITUTE

## Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: St. Anthony Tri Parish Catholic School

School Website: <https://mounthopecasper.com/school/>

January 7, 2026

**Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer**

*This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.*

## Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

### Executive Summary

St Anthony Tri Parish Catholic School WY 82604 appears, in the crawl content provided, to be a school that aligns strongly with classical Christian education principles, though the public-facing materials center on Lutheran confessional education rather than Catholic identity. The site emphasizes formation over information, a liturgical and communal life, a catechetical and gospel-centered curriculum, and a Trivium/Quadrivium-informed structure, all within a confessional Lutheran framework. This combination places the school in the CLASSICAL category across the rubric, with clear strengths in religious foundations, formation-oriented aims, liberal-arts curriculum, traditional pedagogy, engaged faculty, and a model of partnership with parents and church communities.

Key evidence in favor of CLASSICAL alignment includes: explicit statements that the school is a “Premier Classical Lutheran Education” that values the Word of God, Lutheran Confessions, classical languages, and great literature, and that the school seeks to form minds (not merely fill them) while cultivating virtues (Philosophy section). The accreditation material further anchors this in a liturgical and catechetical framework, noting that worship life uses historic liturgy and hymnody and that theology informs and unites instructional programs, with a confessional commitment shaping faculty and the curriculum. The curriculum explicitly centers religion on Scripture (Bible as the heart of the curriculum, chapel as daily practice), and incorporates classical elements (Latin, logic, rhetoric; the Trivium and Quadrivium) across grade levels, including upper-level rhetoric and dialectical training. Pedagogical practice includes contemplative/scholé-oriented approaches, as well as singing, memorization, and a strong upper-school emphasis on Socratic/dialogic forms and liturgical musical training (Choir program). Faculty and leadership are presented as models of virtue and as living curriculum within a cooperative, confessional Lutheran community, with a clearly articulated partnership with families and an open-campus posture for parent involvement. Collectively, these signals align with the classical-school rubric’s core dimensions.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

### Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school describes a confessional Lutheran framework with a gospel-centered mission, explicitly tying curriculum and instruction to Scripture and confessional commitments. - Public-facing materials emphasize the Word of God, Lutheran Confessions, catechesis, and liturgical worship as central to school life (liturgical life, chapel, hymnody).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators present: Word of God, Lutheran Confessions, catechesis, liturgy, hymnody, chapel, gospel-centered instruction. - Negative indicators: None evident in the materials reviewed; there is no emphasis on secular-neutral or purely values-neutral education in the public materials.

Why this rating - The materials repeatedly foreground a theology-infused educational mission, with liturgical worship and catechetical formation as core levers of character and intellect. This maps cleanly to the Positive keyword set for Grounded in Theology and Liturgical/Communal Practices, and to Transcendental Moral Realism through a theologically grounded moral vision. The presence of confessional commitments and worship life anchors category 1 as CLASSICAL.

What would move the needle - No major needle move needed; the category already demonstrates strong classical religious foundations. If desired, explicitly naming the transcendental virtues (truth, goodness,

beauty) and tying them to daily memory work and liturgical year practices could reinforce category 1's placement, though current signals already align well.

Citations: Theological/confessional framing and liturgical life are stated in the school's philosophy and accreditation materials, with explicit references to Gospel-centered education, liturgy/hymnody, and catechesis.

## **Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL**

Evidence - A formation-first aim is explicit: "We seek to form minds, not merely fill them, and to instill virtues, not merely skills" (Premier Classical Lutheran Education). - The mission centers on formation of virtue and human flourishing within a Christian framework rather than a primary emphasis on job-readiness, aligning with formation over information and the pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty within a theologically informed context.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators present: formation, virtue, wisdom, contemplation, love of learning, soul formation, moral imagination. - Negative indicators: none evident in public materials; no emphasis on secular or job-preparation narratives.

Why this rating - The explicit language around forming minds and instilling virtues, coupled with a theologically grounded purpose, matches the Positive keyword signals for this category, supporting CLASSICAL.

What would move the needle - To further solidify, the school could explicitly map daily activities or milestones to the classical telos (true, good, beautiful) within grade-level rubrics, and highlight the Great Conversation or Great Books concepts in marketing materials. If desired, include a short public articulation of paideia goals in non-religious terms to broaden appeal while preserving the core.

Citations: Philosophy and mission statements emphasize formation, virtue, and a theologically grounded purpose.

## **Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL**

Evidence - The curriculum references include Latin, logic, rhetoric across grade bands and a Trivium-based progression, with explicit mention of the Quadrivium in accreditation materials; Bible/Theology forms a core through all grades; history is integrated with other disciplines, not treated as a separate "social studies" silo; and there is a clear emphasis on reading and understanding Great Books and classic works via a liberal-arts approach (via the program's claim of "classical literature" and heavy emphasis on Latin and logic in grades 6–12).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators present: Seven liberal arts framework (grammar/logic/rhetoric), Quadrivium (arithmetic, geometry, music, astronomy), Latin, Bible/Theology, history in integrated form, great literature and classical canon signals. - Negative indicators: The materials do not foreground a project-based or purely social-studies-centric approach; instead, they emphasize classical content and integration.

Why this rating - The presence of grammar/logic/rhetoric, Latin study, and a curricular emphasis on historical/theological texts and classical education signals align with CLASSICAL. The integration of history within a liberal-arts frame and the emphasis on classical languages and primary sources (where described) reinforce this.

What would move the needle - A stronger, explicit articulation of Great Books or Great Conversation in a public-facing way would more clearly align with "Great Books/Great Conversation" explicit criterion; otherwise, the current alignment remains CLASSICAL.

Citations: Curriculum elements including Latin, logic, rhetoric, and the Trivium/Quadrivium framing are documented in curriculum and accreditation content; religion is central with Bible/theology core across grades.

**Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL**

Evidence - Lower-school pedagogy includes singing, chanting, and memory-focused activities (repetition and liturgical/memorial practices). Upper-school pedagogy features Socratic discussion, seminars, and rhetorical training (Latin/logic/rhetoric instruction at higher levels). - The choir program is a central feature, with Kammerchor, Chorale, and Choristers, reinforcing a pedagogy that uses music to cultivate memory and moral imagination; there is also explicit emphasis on rhetoric and public speech in upper grades (9th–12th).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators present: Scholé/restful learning signals (occasional restful contemplation); memorization; chanting; memory work; Socratic seminars; rhetoric; choir-based pedagogy. - Negative indicators: The materials emphasize a strong classical pedagogy rather than modern constructivist or project-based-only approaches; no substantial counter-indications found.

Why this rating - The presence of ladled classical pedagogy signals—restful learning in early grades, memorization/chanting, and upper-level Socratic/rhetoric work—maps squarely onto CLASSICAL pedagogy criteria.

What would move the needle - To maximize clarity, publicly emphasize specific pedagogical sequences (grammar to logic to rhetoric) and provide a short, public-facing pedagogical map linking daily activities to scholé, grammar, dialectic, and rhetoric moments across the grade bands.

Citations: Evidence of singing/chanting in lower grades and Socratic/rhetoric practices in upper grades; choir as a structured pedagogy element; and explicit reference to “Socratic” style instruction in the curriculum materials.

**Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL**

Evidence - The school presents faculty as virtuous, with the faculty serving as the living curriculum and as mentors who exemplify virtue and mastery; the governance emphasizes confessional Lutheran commitments shaping faculty roles and ongoing professional development within a classical framework.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators present: Model/virtue-based faculty; living curriculum; mentorship; collegiality; professional development; moral exemplar. - Negative indicators: No explicit counter-indicators in the materials; no critique of faculty structure.

Why this rating - The emphasis on faculty as living exemplars and mentors aligns with the CLASSICAL indicators for category 5 (model teachers, living curriculum, mentorship, and professional formation).

What would move the needle - To further reinforce, provide a public, explicit “portrait of a teacher” and “portrait of a student” with concrete examples of how faculty model virtue and engage in ongoing classical formation, plus a visible faculty learning community (e.g., seminary-style faculty study groups or seminars).

Citations: The faculty/leadership framing is described in the philosophy and accreditation sections, including the living-curriculum concept and the confessional Lutheran framing.

**Element 6: Parents and Community — CLASSICAL**

Evidence - The school emphasizes partnership with families, parent formation (via the website, book studies, gatherings), and open visitation by parents; Admissions materials describe church-attendance requirements and family involvement, signaling a strong parent-community partnership.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators present: Partnership with families, parent formation, home-school community, open-campus, family catechesis. - Negative indicators: None evident in the public-facing materials reviewed.

Why this rating - The school’s materials emphasize parent involvement as co-educators and the church-family ecosystem that supports classical education; this aligns with the CLASSICAL signals for category 6.

What would move the needle - If desired, add a public-facing section detailing a structured series of parent book studies, family liturgy resources, and a clear schedule for family involvement beyond tours and visits to further emphasize partnership, but the current materials already meet CLASSICAL expectations.

Citations: Partnership with families, parent formation programs, and open visitation are described in Admissions/Christian Culture materials and the broader philosophy content.

Aggregate Assessment - Overall Classification: CLASSICAL - Rationale: Across all six categories, the school's materials consistently align with classical education signals: confessional/theological grounding, formation-oriented aims, liberal-arts curriculum (grammar/logic/rhetoric, Latin, history, Bible/theology), traditional pedagogy (chanting/memory in early grades; Socratic/dialogic and rhetoric in upper grades), a faculty-leadership model rooted in virtue and mentoring, and a strong partnership with parents and the church community. While the materials are rooted in a Lutheran confessional identity rather than Catholic, the classical framework remains strongly present and coherent.

What would move the needle (summary) - For a SCHOOL that is already CLASSICAL, the needle-moving changes are not required to reach CLASSICAL status. If desired, the school could further crystallize public statements about Great Books or the Great Conversation, map classroom practices to a public "grammar–logic–rhetoric" sequence with concrete samples, and provide explicit references to traditional virtues and transcendental aims (truth, goodness, beauty) in everyday materials to strengthen category signals.

## Appendix

### ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

### Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

By reading or using this document, you acknowledge and accept the limitations described above.